

WORLDTREND'S RESEARCH

January 6, 1994

MEMORANDUM TO: 

FROM: 

RE: Project Starlight

The following are some random thoughts after reading the remarkable briefing material you gave me. As I'm a novice in this whole business, these thoughts are probably not too original.

1) Project Starlight must be done right the first time. It must be the manifestation of perfection and attention to detail. If it's unconvincing or second-rate in any manner, it will be a long time before there's a second chance.

To help achieve such perfection, is it worth considering bringing on board Project Starlight someone who has had extensive experience in conceiving and managing a major public announcement? While you certainly don't want to turn the project over to any PR "expert", there might be value in having someone who is intimately associated with the information industry as a resource. Such a resource might help provide both strategy and contacts.

2) This is indeed a global event. So where are the knowledgeable Japanese, Germans, Russians et al in the planning process. For maximum effect, this should not be something planned by Americans, who then bring the rest of the world in on it. The announcement should be planned by representatives of the world. Unless that's done, Project Starlight runs the risk of not being conceived and implemented in a truly global perspective. Having representatives of the rest of the world in the planning process--as well as the briefing process--will add dimensions that would not otherwise be included, and it will avoid some problems that would inevitably arise otherwise.

3) Credibility. This is perhaps the highest criteria. Everything conceivable should be done to achieve highest credibility. I think Steve said that both Presidents Carter and Reagan had seen UFOs, or at least they are convinced of their existence. If that's the case, why not try to get them both to be present at the announcement. The same goes for Billy Graham. What world renown scientists will attend the announcement?

Adding to credibility, the overview paper suggests the venue for the announcement should be the U.N. If this happens, would Secretary General Boutros Boutros-Ghali open the announcement conference?

4) Unless I missed it, the commentary on the media doesn't mention a global TV hookup for the announcement. Would [REDACTED] carry this live, globally on CNN?

5) Vice President Gore. Would he be the best entre into the Clinton Administration? He's more likely to be in tune with Project Starlight than is [REDACTED]. Would Gore attend the announcement? Would he get his counterpart from other countries to attend?

6) Minor point, but avoid cliches. "An idea whose time has come" is mentioned a couple of times. The arrival of ETI is far more than that. Also, avoid any mention of a "world government". Mention that, and political figures will flee, and the media will pigeonhole the whole effort.

7) Steve asks of ETI and humans, "What is our common ground?" "Conscious intelligence" is certainly part of the answer. I would add: (a) We share the same origins; origins which are approximately 15 billion years old. (b) We both have a creative, purposeful awareness, which is the essence of life. (c) We both have the capacity for positive energy, the expression of which perhaps ought to be a primary aim of any eventual contact with ETI.

8) Awareness. In one sense, the history of the human race is the story of expanding awareness. "Let there be light" is essentially the recording of the birth of conscious awareness. That awareness has taken giant strides forward at various points over the last 3500 years.

The last one hundred or so years has seen the greatest stride forward, as humans' awareness that we all are an inherent part of one species has been heightened by the telegraph, telephone, television, airplanes, etc. What we knew theoretically became the stuff of daily economics and geopolitics.

More than any other decade in history, the 1960s saw that awareness expand to its present extent. For it was during the '60s that the human race first saw pictures of the Earth taken from, first, space, and then the moon. Seeing the Earth from the moon was a seminal event in human history, both scientifically and psychologically, for we suddenly saw human existence as it actually is, not as our ideologies, religions and prejudices have portrayed it. We suddenly saw ourselves as one human unit, without all the national, cultural or ethnic boundaries by which we had defined ourselves for centuries. Adjusting to this new condition has been the propelling force of events for the past quarter century.

The arrival of ETI on Earth will be another definitive stride forward in our awareness of ourselves as one human family. I think it will create a serious division between those who can accept it and adjust to what it means, and those who can't. For we haven't yet really psychologically assimilated the significance of seeing Earth from space. We're still struggling with the consequences of that experience. In one sense, it would have been better if the ETI could have given us a few more decades to better absorb the expansion of awareness that's taken place as a result of seeing Earth from space. We haven't yet integrated that into our psyche, to say nothing of our cultural, political or economic attitudes and practices.

But my point is that the announcement in April should be couched in terms of the continuing unfolding of awareness of the oneness of the human family. This is the latest in a long series of milestones in that expanding awareness.

9) Following on what has been said in the previous section is the issue of identity. The question of identity is a critical issue at the heart of every significant problem with which the world is grappling. The concept of nationhood no longer defines us as it once did. Ethnicity no longer defines us, as we see ourselves as part of one human community. (To some degree, most of today's ethnic struggles, from the streets of LA to the hills of Bosnia, are people rebelling against moving beyond the psychological security of their ethnicity.) Religions have lost the inner dynamic that historically gave them their force and shaped culture, and in this sense, religion no longer defines us, although people may turn to it as a source of solace. "Who am I, and where do I fit into the larger scheme of life?" is the crucial question confronting everyone in the world, whether or not we articulate it as such.

Clearly, the arrival of ETI is going to magnify the issue of identity. So the whole announcement should be conceived not in terms of transmitting spectacular information about an epoch-shaping event, but in terms designed to assure people, and to ease people forward in their own perception of who we are. The announcement should not be solely an informational process; above all, it must be an educational process, and it must be carried out with great delicacy.

At the deepest level, Project Starlight is a spiritual/psychological process, and it must be handled with the tenderness and compassion with which a great psychologist would treat a patient for whom he has the deepest concern. Thus the central purpose of Project Starlight should not be limited to the announcement of ETI per se; the central purpose should be to use the announcement and subsequent briefings to encourage and entice our human attitudes and emotions to move forward and to accept and explore the new phase of development the human race has now entered.

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T I M E L I N E

15 billion years ago	The universe begins as stupendous energy, evolving into the gravitational, strong nuclear, weak nuclear, and electromagnetic interactions.
10-14 billion years ago	The universe breaks into galactic clouds. The primal stars appear.
5 billion years ago	A disclike cloud floats in the Orion arm of the Milky Way Galaxy.
4.5 billion years ago	Sun is born.
4.45 billion years ago	Earth brings forth an atmosphere, oceans and continents.
4 billion years ago	The first prokaryotic cell emerges.
700 million years ago	The first multicellular animal appears.
235 million years ago	Dinosaurs appear.
216 million years ago	First mammals.
30 million years ago	First apes.
2.6 million years ago	First humans.
1.5 million years ago	Hunters; homo erectus.
500,000 years ago	Clothing, shelter, fire, hand axes.
40,000 years ago	Language develops.
35,000 years ago	Occupation of the Americas.
10,600 years ago	Settlements in the Middle East.
3500 B.C.	Sumerian civilization; cuneiform writing.
1700 B.C	Origins of the alphabet in Palestine.
1200 B.C.	Greek settlements. Exodus of Israel from Egypt.

560 B.C.	Confucius in China; Buddha in India.
509 B.C.	Founding of Roman Republic.
4 B.C.	Jesus.
410 A.D.	Fall of Rome.
650 A.D.	Muslim empire.
1095 A.D.	Crusades.
1492 A.D.	Columbus sails to America.
1543 A.D.	Copernican revolution.
1609 A.D.	Galileo builds first telescope.
1687 A.D.	Newton explains modern view of the universe.
1809 A.D.	Lamarck traces evolutionary sequence from lower forms to higher forms of life.
1831 A.D.	Invention of the telegraph, enabling human thought instantly to transcend distance.
1876 A.D.	Human voice first transcends large distances with the invention of the telephone.
1900 A.D.	Planck announces first steps toward quantum theory.
1903 A.D.	Humans separate themselves from Earth for the first time with the first successful airplane.
1905 A.D.	Einstein alters basic understanding of time, space, motion, matter and energy.
1924 A.D.	Invention of television, enabling immediate sight to transcend distance.
1929 A.D.	Hubble provides evidence that the universe is expanding.
1945 A.D.	Atomic age arrives.

1965 A.D.

Wilson and Penzias find evidence of the origin of the universe.

1969 A.D.

Humans first explore extraterrestrial landmass by landing on the moon.

1992 A.D.

Verification made that contact has been established with radiation left over from the "Big Bang", the beginning of space, time and matter.

1947-94 A.D.

Evidence accumulates that extraterrestrial life-form is studying Earth.

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